



CYBERSECURITY INTERNSHIP · TASK 2

Phishing Awareness Training

Recognizing deception, understanding attacker psychology, and building safer digital habits

Prepared by **Tehreem** | BS Information Technology

What We'll Cover

A practical walkthrough of phishing threats and defenses



What Is Phishing?

Defining the attack and why it still works



Spotting Fake Emails & Sites

The tell-tale signs attackers can't fully hide



Social Engineering Tactics

The psychological triggers behind every scam



Real-World Scenarios

Common phishing patterns seen today



Best Practices

Simple habits that stop most attacks



Test Your Knowledge

A short interactive check-in



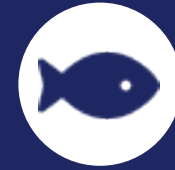
Attackers don't need to break your systems.
They just need one person to click.

Every phishing attempt is a test of attention, not technology — and that makes awareness the single most powerful control an organization has.

What Is Phishing?

Phishing is a form of social engineering in which an attacker impersonates a trusted person, brand, or system to trick someone into revealing sensitive information or taking a harmful action — such as clicking a malicious link, downloading infected files, or transferring money.

- Delivered through email, SMS, phone calls, or fake websites
- Relies on deception, not technical hacking, to succeed
- Remains one of the most common starting points for data breaches



Why It Works

- Exploits trust in familiar names and brands
- Creates urgency so victims act before thinking
- Looks nearly identical to legitimate messages
- Targets people, the hardest layer to patch

Recognizing Phishing Emails

Red flags that usually give a fraudulent email away



Mismatched sender address

A display name looks right, but the actual email domain is subtly altered or unrelated.



Urgent or threatening language

Messages pressure you to act immediately — "verify now" or "account will be suspended."



Suspicious links

Hovering reveals a URL that doesn't match the sender's real domain.



Generic greetings & poor quality

Vague greetings like "Dear Customer," along with spelling or formatting errors.

Suspicious Email — Annotated

From: IT-Support@secure-mail-verify.com

Subject: Immediate Action Required

Dear Customer,

Your account will be suspended in 24 hours.

Click below to verify your identity now:

<http://secure-verify-account.net/login>

Failure to respond immediately will result in permanent account closure.

Spotting Fake Websites

Fraudulent sites are built to look convincing — these checks help confirm authenticity



Check for HTTPS & a valid certificate

A padlock alone isn't proof of safety, but its absence is a warning sign.



Inspect the domain name closely

Watch for misspellings, extra words, or unusual endings (e.g., "-secure", ".xyz").



Look for design inconsistencies

Blurry logos, broken layouts, or outdated branding suggest a cloned site.



Be wary of unexpected pop-ups

Legitimate sites rarely demand credentials through a pop-up window.

Social Engineering Tactics

Phishing succeeds by manipulating emotion and behavior, not by breaking code



Urgency

Rushing decisions before doubts
can form



Authority

Posing as a boss, bank, or
government body



Fear

Threatening fines, suspension, or
legal action



Curiosity

Baiting clicks with prizes or
gossip

Common Real-World Scenarios

Illustrative patterns frequently reported across organizations



Executive Impersonation

An email appears to come from a senior manager, urgently requesting a wire transfer or gift cards, bypassing normal approval steps.



Fake Delivery Notice

A text or email claims a package couldn't be delivered and asks the recipient to "confirm details" via a spoofed courier link.



Account Verification Scam

A message mimics a bank or email provider, warning of suspicious login activity and linking to a cloned login page.

These are generalized, illustrative examples for training purposes and do not reference any specific incident or organization.

Best Practices to Stay Safe

Simple, consistent habits that stop the vast majority of phishing attempts



Pause before clicking — verify urgent requests through a separate, trusted channel



Never share passwords, OTPs, or codes over email, chat, or phone



Report suspicious messages to IT or a security team instead of ignoring them



Hover over links to preview the real destination before clicking



Enable multi-factor authentication on all important accounts



Keep browsers, email clients, and antivirus software up to date



Test Your Knowledge

Five quick multiple-choice questions on phishing awareness

1

An email from "Amazon Security" says your account is locked and links you to "restore access" now. What's the safest first move?

A) Click the link right away to fix it B) Reply asking the sender for more details C) Check the sender's real domain and avoid the link D) Forward it to friends as a warning

2

Which trait is the strongest warning sign of a phishing email?

A) It uses your correct first name B) It demands urgent, immediate action C) It is formatted in HTML D) It includes a company logo

3

A "colleague" urgently emails asking you to buy gift cards and send the codes. What should you do?

A) Buy them right away, since a colleague asked B) Call or message them directly on a known number to confirm C) Ignore the email completely D) Reply to the same email asking to confirm

4

What does a padlock (HTTPS) icon actually guarantee about a website?

A) The site is completely safe and legitimate B) The connection is encrypted, but the site could still be fake C) The site is government-verified D) The site cannot contain malware

5

What is the best action when you spot a suspicious email at work?

A) Delete it immediately and move on B) Reply to unsubscribe from future emails C) Report it to your IT or security team D) Forward it to coworkers to compare notes



Answer Key & Why It Matters

Review each answer to reinforce the reasoning, not just the choice

1

Correct: C

Always verify the sender's real domain before clicking — urgency is designed to skip this step.

2

Correct: B

Manufactured urgency is the clearest fingerprint of a phishing attempt.

3

Correct: B

Verify unusual money or gift-card requests through a separate, trusted channel — never the same email thread.

4

Correct: B

HTTPS only encrypts the connection; it says nothing about who actually owns the site.

5

Correct: C

Reporting protects the wider organization, not just the individual who received it.

Key Takeaways



Phishing targets human trust, not just technical gaps — awareness is the strongest defense.



Slow down on urgent requests; verify through a second, trusted channel before acting.



Small habits — checking sender addresses, hovering over links, enabling MFA — stop most attacks.



When in doubt, report it. Reporting one suspicious message can protect an entire organization.



Thank You

Task 2 — Phishing Awareness Training | Prepared by Tehreem | CodeAlpha Internship